



Duress System Personal Leschen Unit Procedure

1. Scope

Site	Operational Area	Applicable to
Armada Mental Health Service	Mental Health	All Staff

2. Purpose

The Armada Mental Health Service endeavours to meet its occupational safety and health responsibilities to protect staff and official visitors from harm by providing duress alarms wherever they have been assessed as necessary. While duress alarms do not prevent violence or aggression, they allow staff and official visitors to call for immediate assistance when in a duress situation.

The duress response system is provided to staff and official visitors to provide urgent assistance to anyone who may be in a threatening situation or is under attack.

Staff and official visitors within the Leschen Unit, must always call for assistance and activate the duress alarm or personal alarm, when available, when experiencing or witnessing:

- Violent behaviour
- Aggression or threats towards staff, consumers and/or visitors.

Staff and official visitors should ensure their own safety. If and/or when it is safe to do so, staff should summon assistance by:

- Calling '55' and declaring a **Code Black** (where appropriate)
- Activating a Duress Alarm (where available)
- Calling Security directly.

It is the responsibility of every staff member and official visitor to ensure they carry and understand how to activate the Personal Duress Pendant issued to them to ensure their own safety; the safety of other staff, consumers and visitors.

This document should be read in conjunction with the [Armada Health Service Emergency Response Plan: Code Black](#)

3. Procedure

3.1 Allocation of Personal Duress Pendants to Staff and Official Visitors

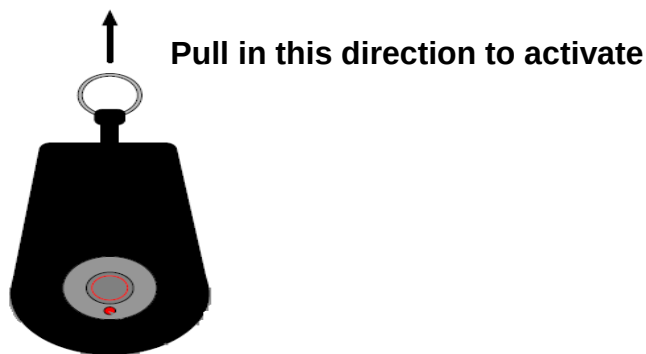
- Personal duress pendants have been allocated for use by staff and official visitors throughout the Leschen Unit.
- Access to the Personal Duress Pendants is the responsibility of the managers for these areas:

Before referencing this procedure document please ensure that you have the latest version from the [Policy Library](#) information hub page.

- Reception and Management Corridor – Clerical Coordinator Mental Health
- Banksia Ward – Associate Nurse Unit Manager
- Karri Ward – Associate Nurse Unit Manager
- Moodjar and Yorgum Wards – Associate Nurse Unit Manager
- Occupational / Day Therapy – Occupational Therapy Assistants
- Welfare Officer and Senior Social Worker – Senior Social Worker

3.2 Use of the Personal Duress Pendant

- The responsibility for orientating new staff to the duress system is the:
 - Clerical Coordinator Mental Health - Reception and Management Corridor
 - Nursing Coordinator – Occupational / Day Therapy/ Social Work
 - Nurse Unit Manager – Associate Nurse Unit Managers/ AH CNS team
 - Staff Development Nurse and Nursing Shift Coordinators – Inpatient Units
- The duress pendant is activated by the pull tag on the top of the unit and should be reset by pushing the tag back into original position.



- Pagers will sound at the activation of the alarm and display a location in text. The pagers are allocated to: ANUM Adult Acute, ANUM Banksia Ward, ANUM Karri Ward and nursing staff in Moodjar, Yorgum, Karri and Banksia wards
- Computers installed with the Guardian software will display an alert in text.
- An audible alarm will be activated from the wall display panels located in Reception, Yorgum Staff Station, Moodjar Staff Station, Karri Staff Station and Banksia Staff Station
- Large display screen located in the Moodjar Yorgum thoroughfare will display the activation location on a map.
- Armadale Health Service Security will receive an audible and visual display of the activation location.
- Once a Personal Duress Pendant has been activated for a code black – Armadale Health Service Security and staff within the immediate area will respond. Staff in the immediate area responding to the duress alarm will be directed by the clinician managing the situation. Deactivation of the alarms will be at the direction of the lead clinician.

3.3 Testing Duress Pendants

There are two test stations installed in the Leschen building, located in the corridor leading into the Unit from Hughes Way

- The test cycle for all duress pendants is: weekly/Sunday



- The Mental Health Afterhours Clinical Nurse Specialist is responsible for ensuring the test cycle is conducted for all duress pendants.
- In the Guardian Trigger Test Box, turn the switch to the 'TEST' position.
- Insert the Personal Duress Pendant into the Guardian Trigger Test Box to isolate the pendant from the alarm sensors.
- Pull the activator on the Personal Duress Pendant. The unit will transmit and the test station should sound audible feedback and the red light above 'TRIGGER OK' should illuminate to provide a visual cue.
- Reset the rip out activator before removing the pendant from the Test Box.
- After 5 seconds, 'RESET' the 'TEST' switch before testing the next duress pendant.
- **Failed test:** if either of the pass conditions fail, the duress pendant must be removed from use and the fault reported to the Nurse Unit Manager as soon as practicable. If there is any doubt as to the functioning of the Personal Duress Pendant it is to be reported to the Nurse Unit Manager immediately.
- The Nurse Unit Manager is to submit an EMPAC and take any other remedial action as required, e.g. request a replacement pendant; issue another pendant to the relevant staff member.
- The Duress Pendant battery is to be replaced annually.
- The 'Duress Pendant Test Register' is to be completed after each test cycle. The electronic copy of the 'Duress Pendant Test Register' is located on W Drive: W:\Mental Health\AKH\Mental Health\General\OSH\Duress System

4. Legislative context

The following documents are required to give effect to this procedure:

- *Occupational Health and Safety Act 1984*
- Health Department of Western Australia (HDWA) [Clinical Incident Management Policy MP 0122/19](#)
- Chief Psychiatrist [Reporting of Notifiable incidents to the Chief Psychiatrist Policy](#)
- East Metropolitan Health Service (EMHS) [Duress Alarm System EMHS: 15](#)

- EMHS [Prevention and Management of Workplace Aggression and Violence Policy EMHS: 127](#)
- EMHS [Incident and Hazard Reporting Policy EMHS: 06](#)

5. Supporting information

The following documents support the implementation of this procedure:

- [Onsite Duress and Code Blue Systems Testing Procedure AKG-PRO-0511-19](#)

6. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Compliance against this policy will be monitored via the Work Place Inspection (WPI) process with completed Duress Pendant Tests Register Forms being included in the WPI report.

7. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

- Standard 1 – Action 1.30 Safe environment
- Standard 1 – Action 5.34 Predicting, preventing and management self-harm and suicide
- Standard 5 – Action 5:33 – Predicting, preventing and managing aggression and violence

8. Policy owner (relating to these procedures)

Enquiries relating to this procedure may be directed to:

Title: Service Director Mental Health
 Department: Mental Health
 Email: Karen.Elliott@health.wa.gov.au

9. Review

This procedure will be reviewed and evaluated as required to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
V5	16/07/2024	16/07/2027	

10. Authorisation

This procedure has been authorised and issued by the Service Director Mental Health.

Authorised by	Shannon Stuart – Acting Service Director Mental Health
Authorisation date	16/07/2024
Published date	16/07/2024